

Opportunity Insights Brand DNA

VERSION 1.0 / JUNE 2018



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Our Brand



Introduction

Our brand is the sum total of words, images, aesthetics, emotions and experiences that come to mind when our target audiences think about us. It's reflected in who we are, how we work, what we look like, and the ways in which we communicate. Because our brand lives in our target audiences, it can't be controlled. It can, however, be built.

Our goal is to build a brand that is authentic to who we are, distinctive amongst our peers, connects with our audiences, and provides them the data and tools they need to create policy that promotes upward mobility.

This Brand DNA provides guidance on our values, aesthetics, and language.

Let's start building.

Purpose

The defining feature of the American Dream is upward mobility - the idea that all children have a chance at economic success, no matter their background.

However, our research shows that children's chances of earning more than their parents have declined by 40 percent over the last fifty years. Today, only half of all children earn more than their parents did. Geography, race, and family income inevitably shape an individual's economic future far more than their innate ability. The American Dream is fading.

Opportunity Insights strives to combat the inequality in American opportunity by collaborating with policymakers to work toward better outcomes for the next generation.

Our researchers gather, analyze, and publish "big data" culled from anonymized government records to demonstrate the strong intergenerational patterns which link childhood circumstances to adult outcomes.

We make our data open and accessible in order to inform the work of decision makers everywhere. Our partnerships with policymakers and civic leaders around the country target local interventions with evidence-based precision and revive the American Dream one community at a time.

Vision

A future where the American Dream is available to everyone.

Mission

To use big data to empower policymakers and civic leaders to create targeted solutions to local challenges and, in doing so, revive the American Dream.

Brand Values

Your brand values are the essence of your organization. They are who you are, how you work, and how you communicate.

Approachable

Definitive

Unifying

Approachable

We communicate and visualize data in ways that help our audiences understand our analysis.

MESSAGING

We try our best to avoid jargon, share summaries of our papers and findings, and tell stories of real people to bring the data to life.

DESIGN

We depict data in its simplest form, use illustrations and photography to make content accessible, and employ a restrained palette to make designs clear and direct.

USER EXPERIENCE

Helpful, clear, digestible

“Opportunity Insights produces content I can easily engage with—they’re careful to highlight the key data and help me understand the impact of their findings. I can quickly find the information I’m looking for on the site, and it’s designed in a way that allows me to interact at a surface level, or dive deep into specific topics I’m more interested in.”

“If you can’t explain it simply,
you don’t understand it well
enough.”

Albert Einstein

Definitive

Our world-class team conducts rigorous, scientific research to authoritatively answer fundamental questions about economic mobility.

MESSAGING

We humbly reference the experience of our team, the depth of our research, the strength of our partnerships, and the recognition of our work to reinforce our credibility.

DESIGN

We take a simple, bold approach to color and typography and avoid texture in favor of flat graphics to make designs strong and authoritative.

USER EXPERIENCE

Empowering, undisputed, credible

“Opportunity Insights is the leader on the topic of upward mobility in America. They uphold scientific integrity—their work is thorough and factual, not fluffy or political, and their research is covered in today’s biggest publications, like NYT Upshot and The Economist. The Opportunity Insights site offers a wealth of information. I can explore the research findings, see how others are using the data, and interact directly with their data tools, which push me to think critically.”

“Great leaders don’t set out to be a leader, they set out to make a difference.”

Author Unknown

Unifying

We are a nonpartisan, not-for-profit, research initiative committed to reviving the American Dream; our independence invites all Americans to unite together and create opportunity for our nation's children.

“Alone we can do so little;
together we can do so much.”

Helen Keller

MESSAGING

We're careful not to use terminology that marginalizes or polarizes, and we passionately share our belief that restoring the American Dream is beneficial for everyone.

DESIGN

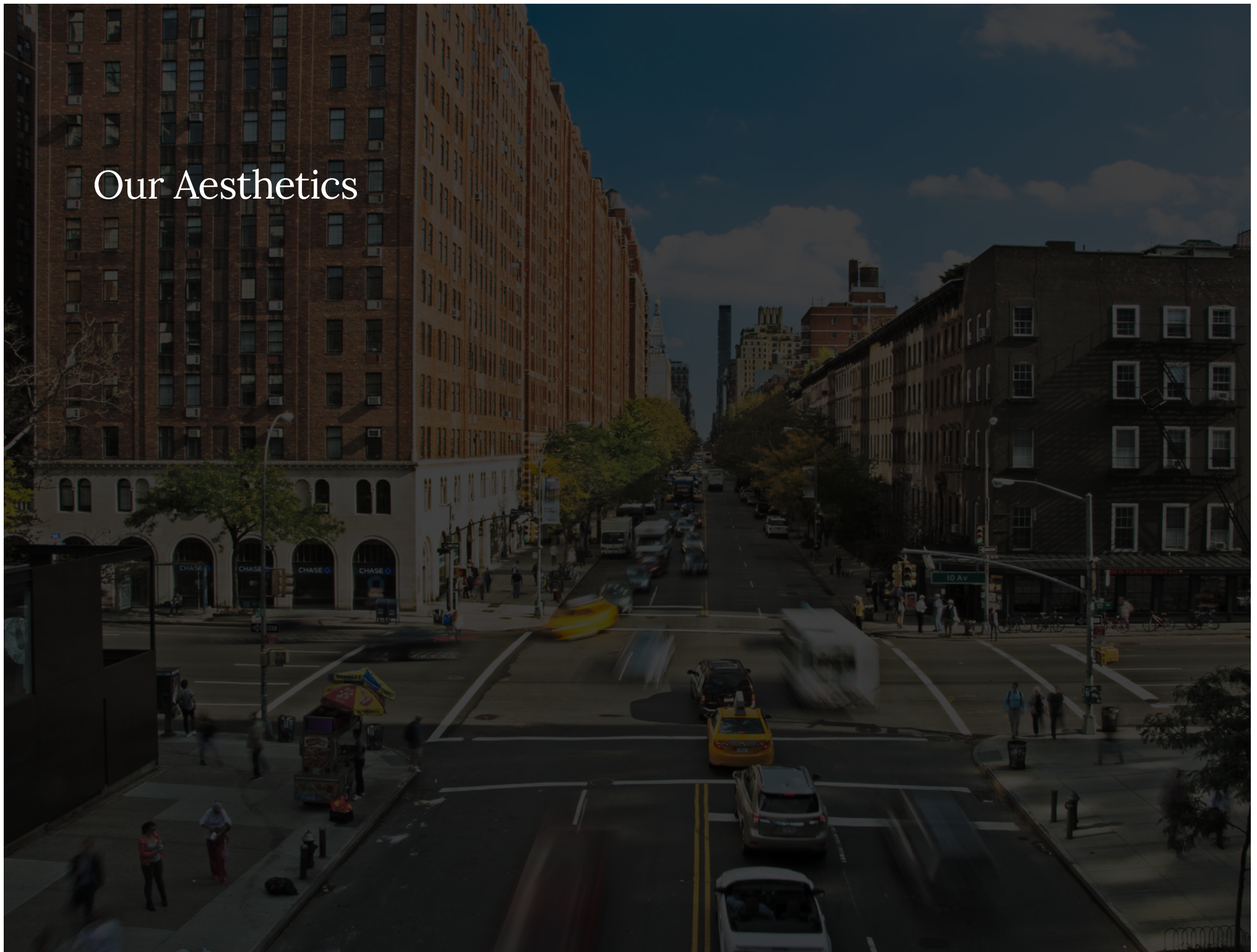
We utilize authentic imagery that feels candid and is inclusive, multiracial, and apolitical. We avoid partisan colors in favor of a neutral palette with bright accent colors.

EXPERIENCE

Data-driven, authentic, American

“Opportunity Insights shares comprehensive and powerful data, and they ensure the data leads the conversation. While their work is data-driven, the organization doesn't lack emotion. It's clear they're passionate about increasing upward mobility in America and providing children with more opportunities tomorrow than they have today, but their advocacy for opportunity isn't tied to a specific party or policy. They remain independent and their website provides a common space for people to learn.”

Our Aesthetics



Visual Language

Opportunity Insights' visual language needs to present a distinct, recognizable “look and feel” that unifies the brand.

An organization's “look” is defined by strategic use of color, typography, photography and graphics.
An organization's “feel” is the emotional sum of those parts.

These attributes are the foundation for all stylistic choices.

Note: Some examples of the visual direction are currently sourced from existing sites around the web, examples are to be replaced with your own digital assets as they are created over time.

Logo

The Opportunity Insights logo should appear as shown in all print and/or digital applications.

The LOGO consists of two basic elements, the LOGOTYPE (“Opportunity Insights”) and the LOGOMARK (“dot bar graph”). These elements should not be rearranged or altered in any way.

CLEAR SPACE

It is important to give the logo clear space to ensure that it stands out from other elements surrounding it such as type, photos, and graphics.

As a rule of thumb, the empty space around the logo should be at least the width of two grid squares.

MINIMUM SIZE

The minimum size the logo can be used and still remain readable is 1.25 inches for print, or 175 pixels wide for web. There is no maximum size restriction.



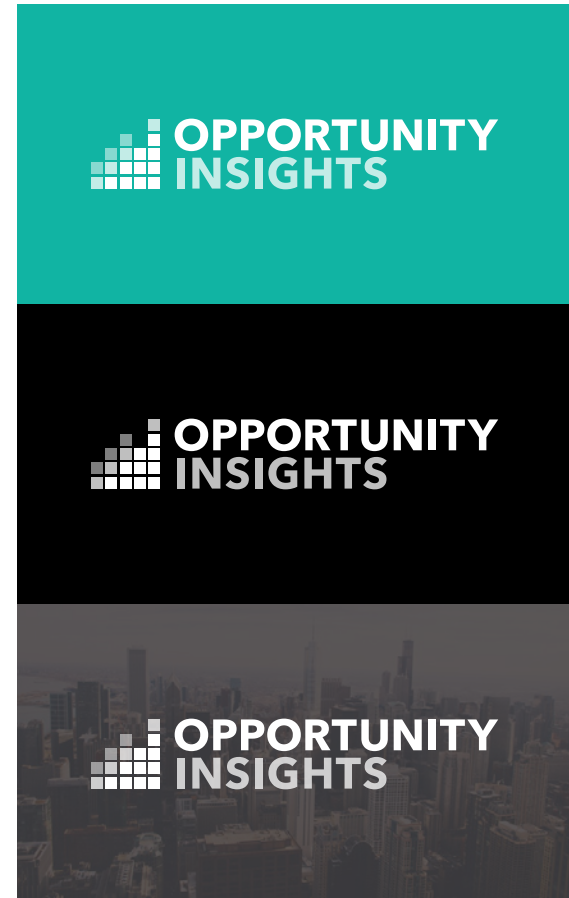
MINIMUM SIZE
1.25 INCH / 175 PX

Logo Versions

Use only approved color options provided for the logo. Use the color version if the logo appears over white or light colored backgrounds. If the background is black or dark, use the white version of the logo.

The “grayscale” logo should be reserved for use only when full color reproduction is not possible.

In the case of a busy background (such as a photograph), apply a tint of black over the photo to increase contrast enough to make the logo stand out.



Logo Usage

To establish and reinforce awareness and recognition of the Opportunity Insights logo, consistent reproduction is essential.

Any changes to the shape and color of the logo will reduce its impact and, over time, deteriorate brand recognition. Avoid altering the logo in any way, and always use the approved logo files provided with this document.

THINGS TO AVOID:

- Do not skew proportions
- Do not use color logo over clashing colors backgrounds or photos
- Do not change the colors
- Do not change arrangement or type
- Do not add filters or other graphic elements: drop shadow, outline, etc.
- Do not overlay logo over competing background



DO NOT SKEW PROPORTIONS



DO NOT USE OVER CLASHING COLORS



DO NOT CHANGE THE COLORS



DO NOT CHANGE ARRANGEMENT OR TYPE



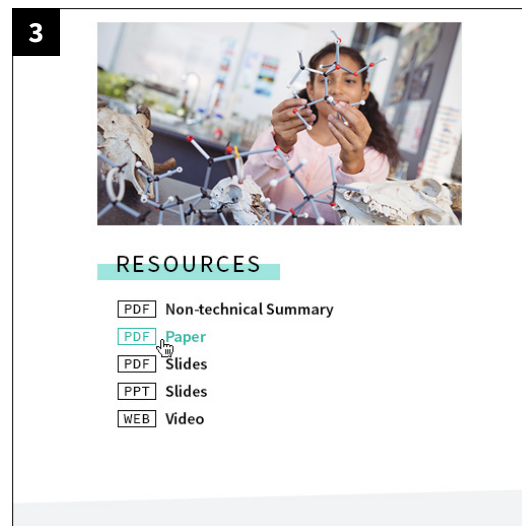
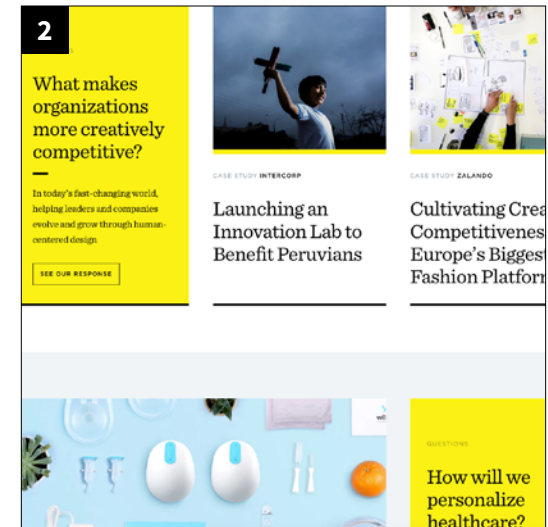
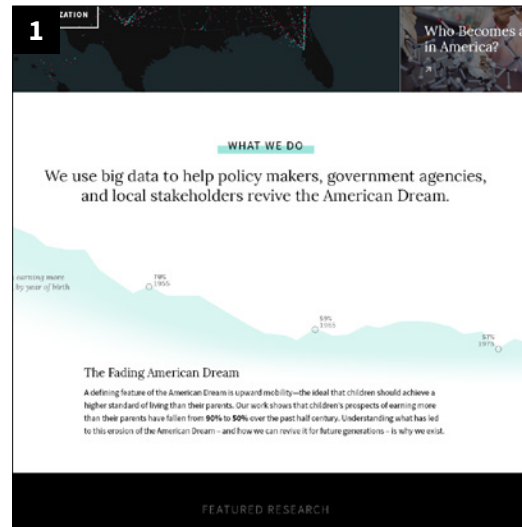
DO NOT ADD FILTERS OR OTHER GRAPHIC ELEMENTS: DROP SHADOW, OUTLINE, ETC.



DO NOT USE OVER BUSY PHOTOS

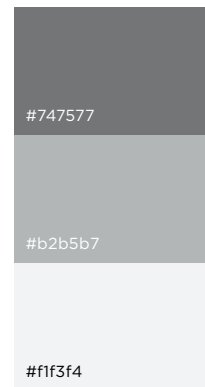
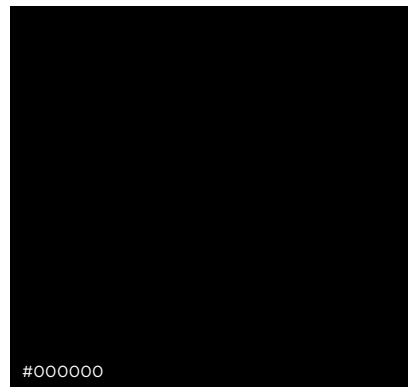
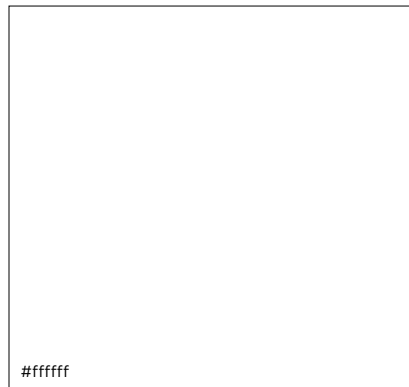
Color

1. Use a grayscale palette (black, white and gray) with one dominant accent color to bring content to life.
2. Allow the text to remain neutral with minimal use of solid backgrounds (black, gray or accent color).
3. Use full-color imagery to add color and inject a sense of vitality and action.
4. Employ a supplementary palette for expanded uses including data visualization.

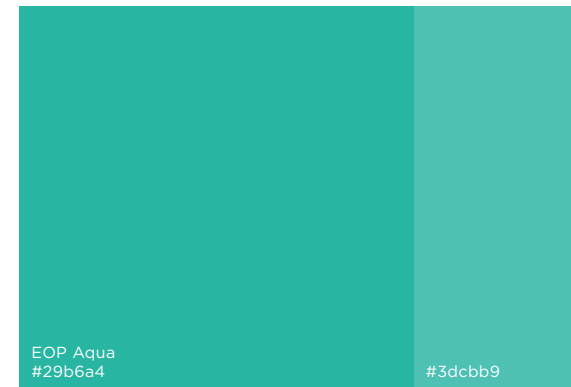


Color Palette

PRIMARY GRAYSCALE PALETTE



PRIMARY ACCENT COLOR



Aqua green is appropriate as an accent color due to its associations with clarity of thought, balance, and growth.

SUPPLEMENTARY PALETTE

#217338	#54963d	#81a244	#133f3c	#1b7372	#64a4a5	#0c5c80	#002e3f	#643974	#b2324d	#c28229	#c8a625
#2b8f43	#6bbd45	#a4ce4e	#015b59	#1f8f8d	#7bcdce	#0073a2	#003a4f	#7f4892	#e54060	#faa523	#ffd400
#5e9e5d	#89c767	#b6d671	#41706f	#5a9e9d	#94d5d6	#5086af	#375265	#9167a3	#ea6b78	#fcb653	#ffdb4f
#84b07f	#a6d38c	#c7df93	#6a898a	#82b0b1	#afdfef	#7a9dbf	#5e6f80	#a685b4	#ee8e92	#fdc67c	#ffe27f
#a8c3a1	#c2e0af	#d8e8b5	#95a8aa	#a8c6c6	#c9e8e9	#a2b7d1	#8993a1	#bfa8ca	#f2b3b2	#fed8a4	#ffeaa8

Typography

1. Combine a serif typeface for headings with a sans serif typeface for body copy to convey credibility.
2. Mix type styles to establish hierarchy and distinguish between different types of information.
3. Introduce a monospaced accent typeface to create a subtle visual reference to data / calculators.
4. Use oversized type to highlight information while maintaining overall balance.

1

INNOVATION

Who Becomes an Inventor in America? Exposure to Innovation

Alex Bell, Raj Chetty, Xavier Jaravel, Neviana Petkova

NBER WORKING PAPER NO. 24062 | DECEMBER 2017

Summary mollis, est non commodo luctus, nisi erat porttitor odio. Maecenas posuere blandit massa nec elit. Praesent commodo cursus magna, vel scelerisque in ultricies. Suspendisse nam justo ipsum a tristique ante. Morbi leo risus, porta ac consectetur ac, vestibulum at eros.

2

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN

Policymakers looking to fuel the engine of innovation, “Einstein’s” should consider:

1. Identifying female, minority, and low-income students who excel at STEM in early ages
2. Increasing overall exposure to STEM through tailored mentorship programs and structural changes in schools and universities

3



→ INNOVATION

Who Becomes an Inventor in America? The Importance of Exposure to Innovation

Alex Bell, Raj Chetty, Xavier Jaravel, Neviana Petkova, and John Van Reenen

DECEMBER 2017

4

Launching an Online Pharmacy Startup

Designing strategies for a venture that redefines how customers engage with pharmacies

CLIENT: PILLPACK

THE CHALLENGE

Help PillPack, an IDEO startup-in-residence, build a venturing strategy for its prescription home-delivery system.

THE OUTCOME

A refined brand vision, strategy across channels, as well as a website, a private dashboard for customers, and a suite of products.

Typography

Primary Typefaces

Source Code Pro — EXAMPLE OF ACCENT TYPEFACE

Lora — Example of
heading natoque
penatibus et
magnis dis
parturient montes.

Source Sans Pro — Example of body copy. Morbi leo risus, porta ac consectetur ac, vestibulum at eros. Etiam porta sem malesuada italic sample mollis euismod. Cras justo odio, dapibus ac facilisis in, egestas eget quam. Donec sed odio dui. Praesent cursus magna, vel scelerisque nisl consectetur et. Maecenas faucibus mollis interdum. Integer posuere erat a ante venenatis dapibus posuere velit aliquet.

Alternative System Typefaces

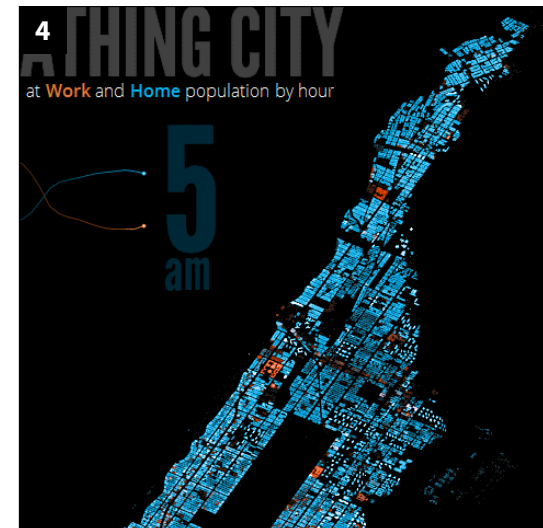
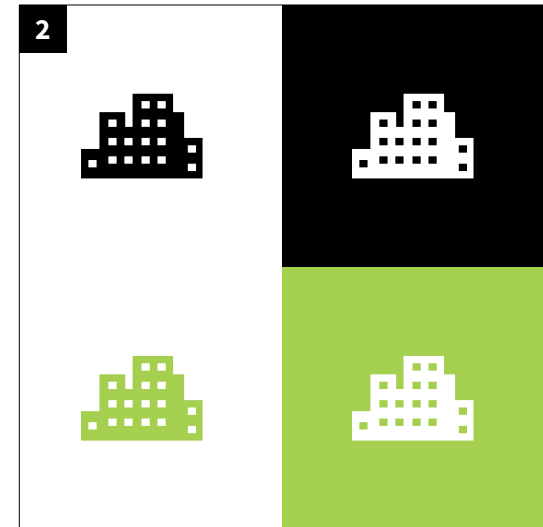
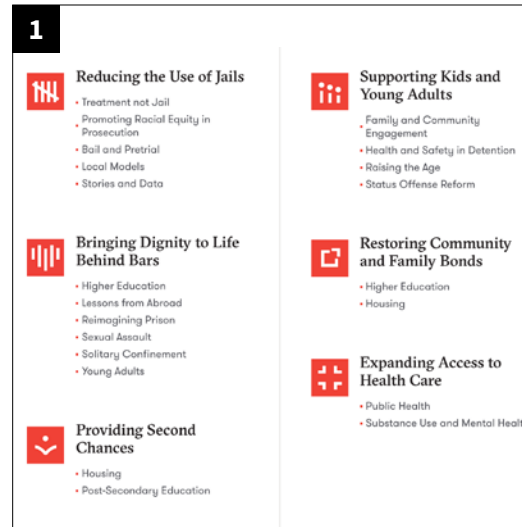
Lucida Sans — EXAMPLE OF ACCENT TYPEFACE

Typewriter
Lucida Roman — Example of
heading natoque
penatibus et
magnis dis
parturient montes.

Lucida Sans — Example of body copy. Morbi leo risus, porta ac consectetur ac, vestibulum at eros. Etiam porta sem malesuada italic sample mollis euismod. Cras justo odio, dapibus ac facilisis in, egestas eget quam. Donec sed odio dui. Praesent cursus magna, vel scelerisque nisl consectetur et. Maecenas faucibus mollis interdum. Integer posuere erat a ante venenatis dapibus posuere velit aliquet.

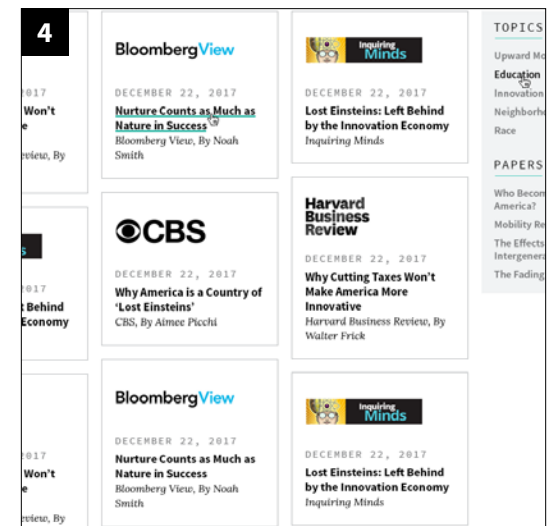
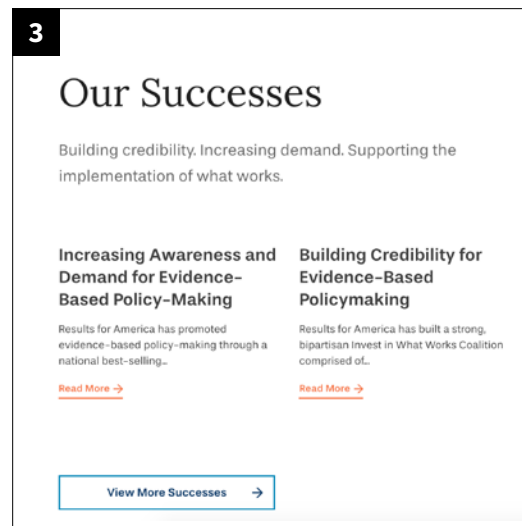
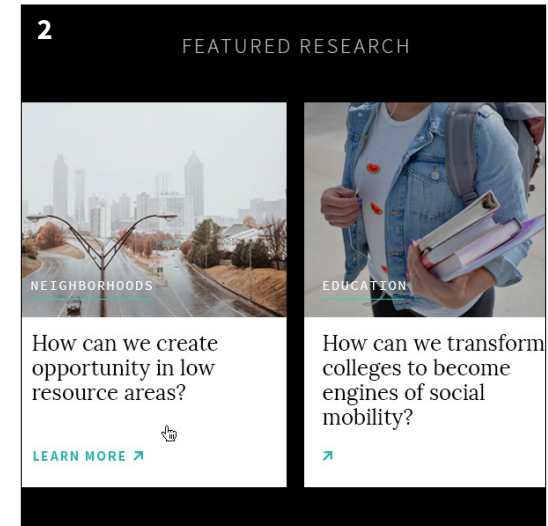
Icons & Illustrations

1. Build a library of simple icons to keep users engaged and to make complex ideas more approachable.
2. Opt for solid, single-color icons over white or solid, white icons over a color.
3. Commission or purchase flat, graphic illustrations to add interest to articles when photography is not available / appropriate.
4. Implement sophisticated, interactive data visualization to demonstrate findings.



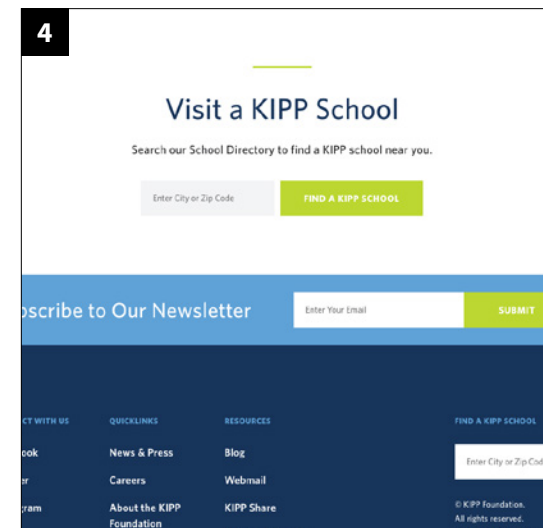
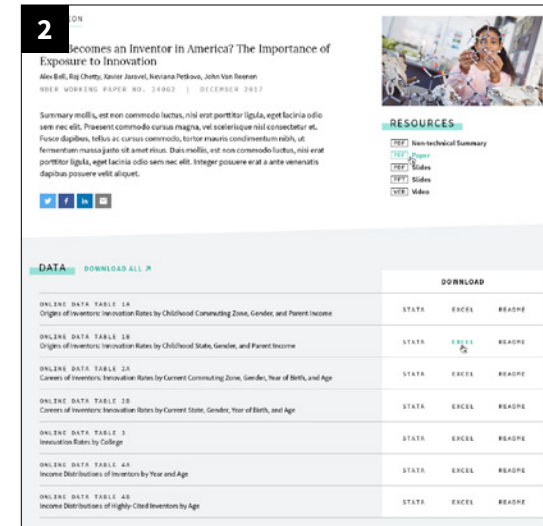
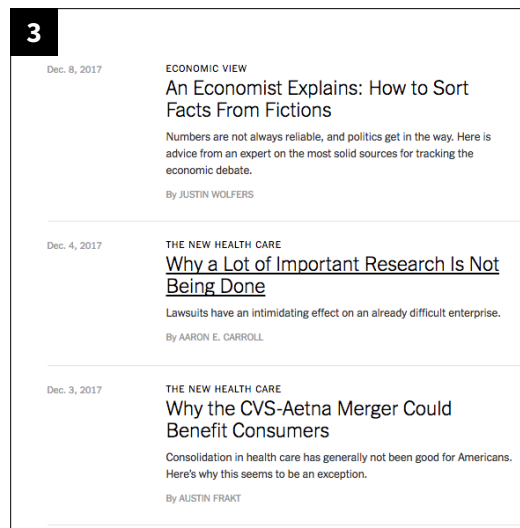
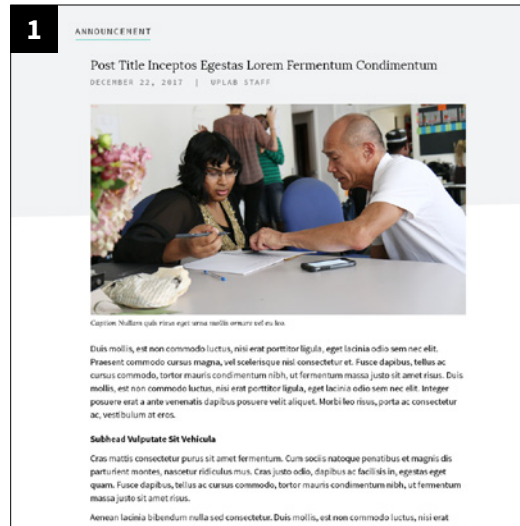
Form & Use of Space

1. Employ a clean typographic style with ample margins and white space to communicate a clean, modern sensibility.
2. Highlight important content in modular blocks with healthy amounts of space between graphic elements.
3. Group information into organized clusters that allow users to easily scan different types of information.
4. Use grids to clearly organize content and divide information.



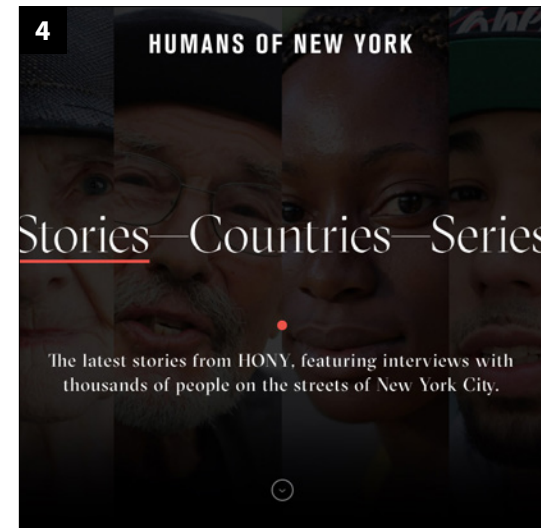
Visual Treatments & Textures

1. Employ areas of flat, solid color in keeping with a simple, modern aesthetic.
2. Use angles to cut images and backgrounds to reinforce the notion of up and to the right progress, but keep angles subtle and isolated to avoid visual competition.
3. Use lines and underlines to divide and highlight information.
4. Avoid textures, grunge, or drop shadows for any images, shapes or UI elements in favor of a clean look.



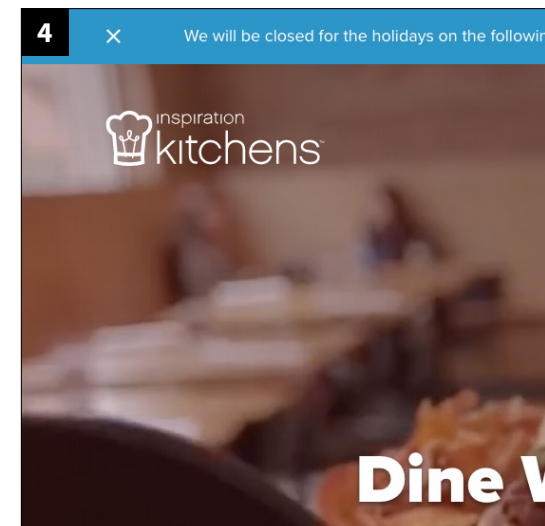
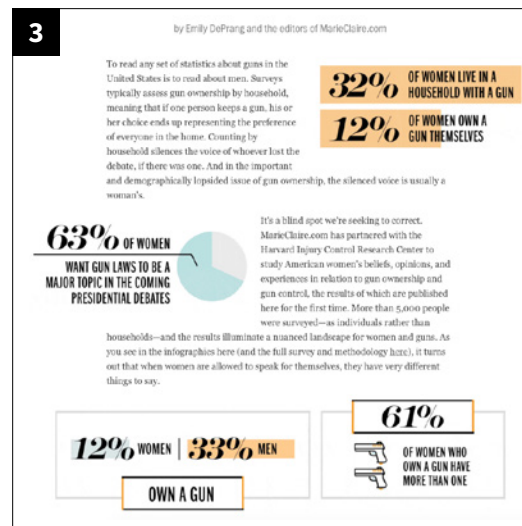
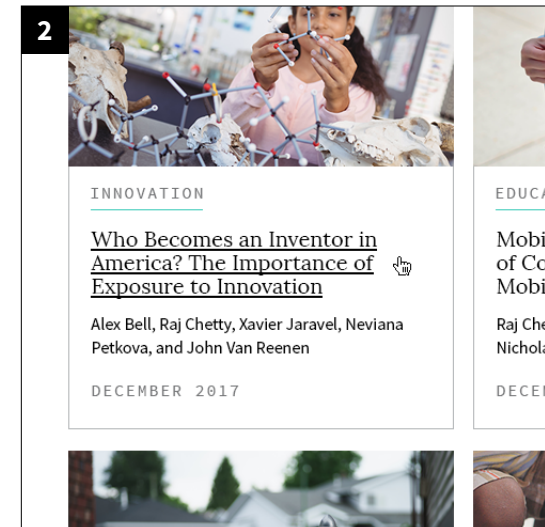
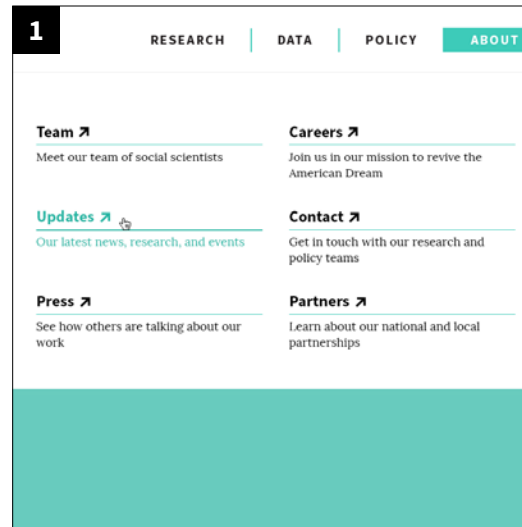
Photography

1. Use photo journalistic images from newsy sources like the Associated Press or commission original photography. If using stock photography, opt for editorial-like images that feel more candid than staged.
2. Use environmental shots when setting up a topic. Include people whenever possible to make content feel more personal.
3. Employ close-ups of faces when telling a story to forge a connection with users and make stories feel more engaging.
4. If placing type over images, opt for black overlays (with opacity reduced) rather than color for contrast and readability.



UI Elements

1. Employ mega menu navigation to give greater context to the sub-pages by including descriptions for each link.
2. Call attention to links with underlines and highlights on rollover. Rounded buttons can be utilized for user interactions (dropdowns, toggles, etc.)
3. Use simple animations to create engagement with data and numbers.
4. Implement an announcement bar and/or pop-over to highlight important information and events.



Our Language



Guidelines

When writing for Opportunity Insights remember every communication is part of a conversation, and every conversation must add value.

CONSIDER YOUR AUDIENCE

Keep in mind what they care about, how informed they are on the topic, and connect with them on their terms. Always respect their time.

CONSIDER YOUR MEDIA

Each type of media (print, web, social, video) has strengths and weaknesses. Embrace these constraints and strive to maximize each touchpoint.

MAKE IT PERSONAL

The more personalized your communication, the more likely it will be read and appreciated by the reader. Get creative and seek to personalize each touchpoint as much as possible.

Tone

Our tone must be consistent, intentional and authentic.

We speak authoritatively about our research and findings, yet in a manner that invites all audiences to interact with our work.

Authoritative / confident / direct

Accessible / straightforward / clear

Editorial

The words we choose influence the experiences we create and the interactions we have with our audiences.

- We write in the first person (we, our).
- We directly address our reader (you), when appropriate.
- We use as little jargon as possible.
- We don't shy away from our expert status.
- We let the data lead the story.
- We remain politically independent and avoid polarizing terms.
- We never sugar coat or avoid the truth.
- We uplift and speak positively of our partners.

Boilerplate Statement

Our “boilerplate” is our standard organization description which should be used repeatedly and across media without change.

Opportunity Insights is a non-partisan, not-for-profit initiative committed to combatting the decline of the American Dream. We gather, analyze and publish “big data” to answer the most fundamental questions about inequality in America. Through our partnerships with policymakers and civic leaders, we develop targeted local interventions that create opportunity for future generations.